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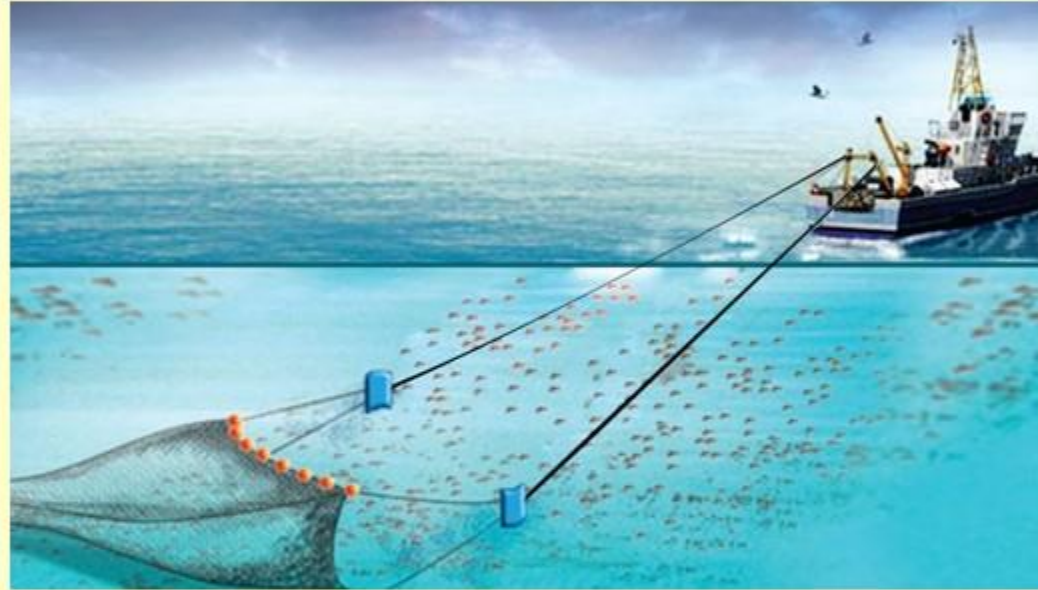
Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

11th July, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

28th WEEK



BOTTOM TRAWLING

UPSC CSE – GS III

**GS III ... ENVIRONMENTAL POLLUTION AND DEGRADATION,
ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT ASSESSMENT.**

2

Targeting trawling

Tamil Nadu must hasten the transition from trawling to deep sea fishing

Sri Lanka's legislative amendment to prohibit bottom trawling, a destructive fishing practice, is a welcome move despite its likely near-term consequence of deepening the fisheries conflict in the Palk Bay region. Bottom trawling in the island nation's territorial waters will now attract a possible two-year prison term and a fine of 50,000 Sri Lankan rupees. The practice, which involves trawlers dragging weighted nets along the sea floor, is known to cause great depletion of fishery resources, and curbing it is in the interest of sustainable fishing. The initial reaction from Tamil Nadu has been one of concern and consternation. Political parties claim the amendment is draconian, and that it is targeted at the State's fishermen who regularly use hundreds of trawlers in Sri Lankan territorial waters. This criticism is way off the mark. In recent years, some fishermen in northern Sri Lanka have also adopted bottom trawling. If this practice continues to gain ground even among local fishermen, the long-term consequences on fishing resources in the contested Palk Bay region will be irremediable. The amendment is aimed at curbing local trawlers as well as deterring trawlers from Tamil Nadu. An appropriate response from Tamil Nadu would be to expedite the conversion of its trawlers to deep sea fishing vessels, and not merely condemn Sri Lanka.

Fishermen from both countries have been in talks for a long time to resolve the conflict. Sri Lankan fishermen want an immediate end to incursions by Indian trawlers, and those from Tamil Nadu insist on a three-year phase-out period. The proposal to ban bottom trawling is two years old, but the amendment has come at a time when a Joint Working Group set up by both countries last year is in place. Tamil Nadu fishermen are arrested from time to time by the Sri Lankan Navy, and their vessels seized. If more are arrested and slapped with two-year jail terms after a summary trial, as the law now envisages, it may create new flashpoints. Ultimately, the

THE  HINDU

Date : 11th July, 2017



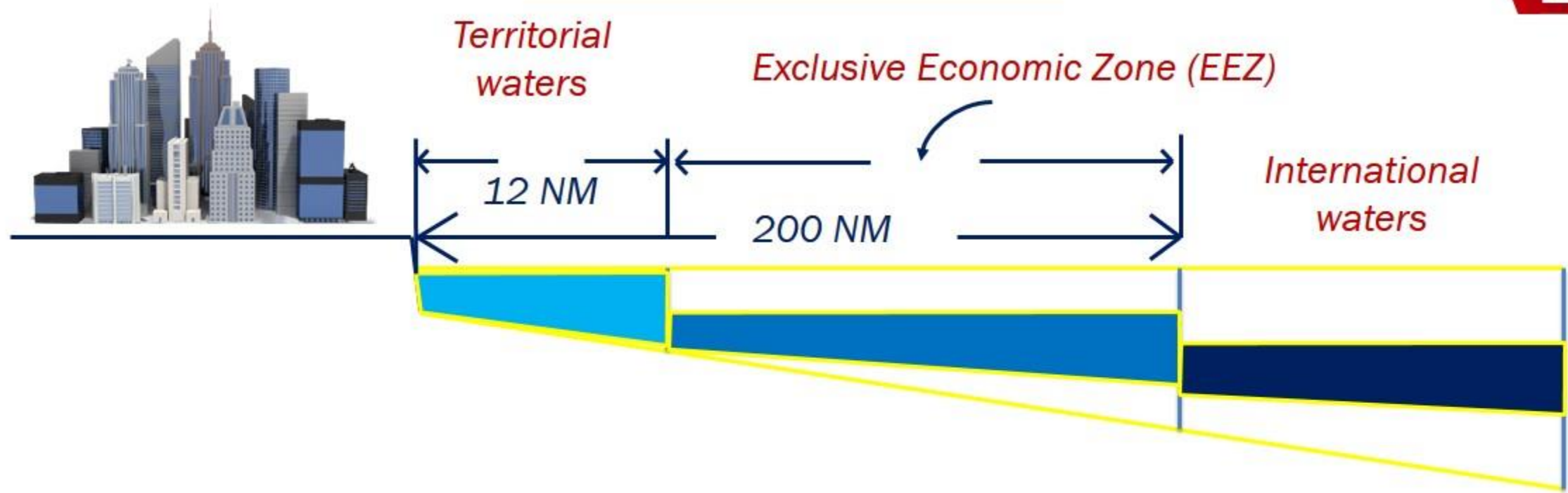
Maithripala Sirisena
President, Sri Lanka



Ranil Wickremasinghe
Prime Minister, Sri Lanka

NEWS REPORT

- 1** Sri Lankan Legislature prohibited bottom trawling.
- 2** It is a destructive fishing practice.
- 3** Bottom trawling in the island nations territorial waters will now attract a possible two year prison term and a fine of 50,000 Sri Lankan rupees.



TERRITORIAL WATERS

Sovereignty of the airspace above and the seabed below. Ships will be given "Innocent Passage".

EXCLUSIVE ECONOMIC ZONE

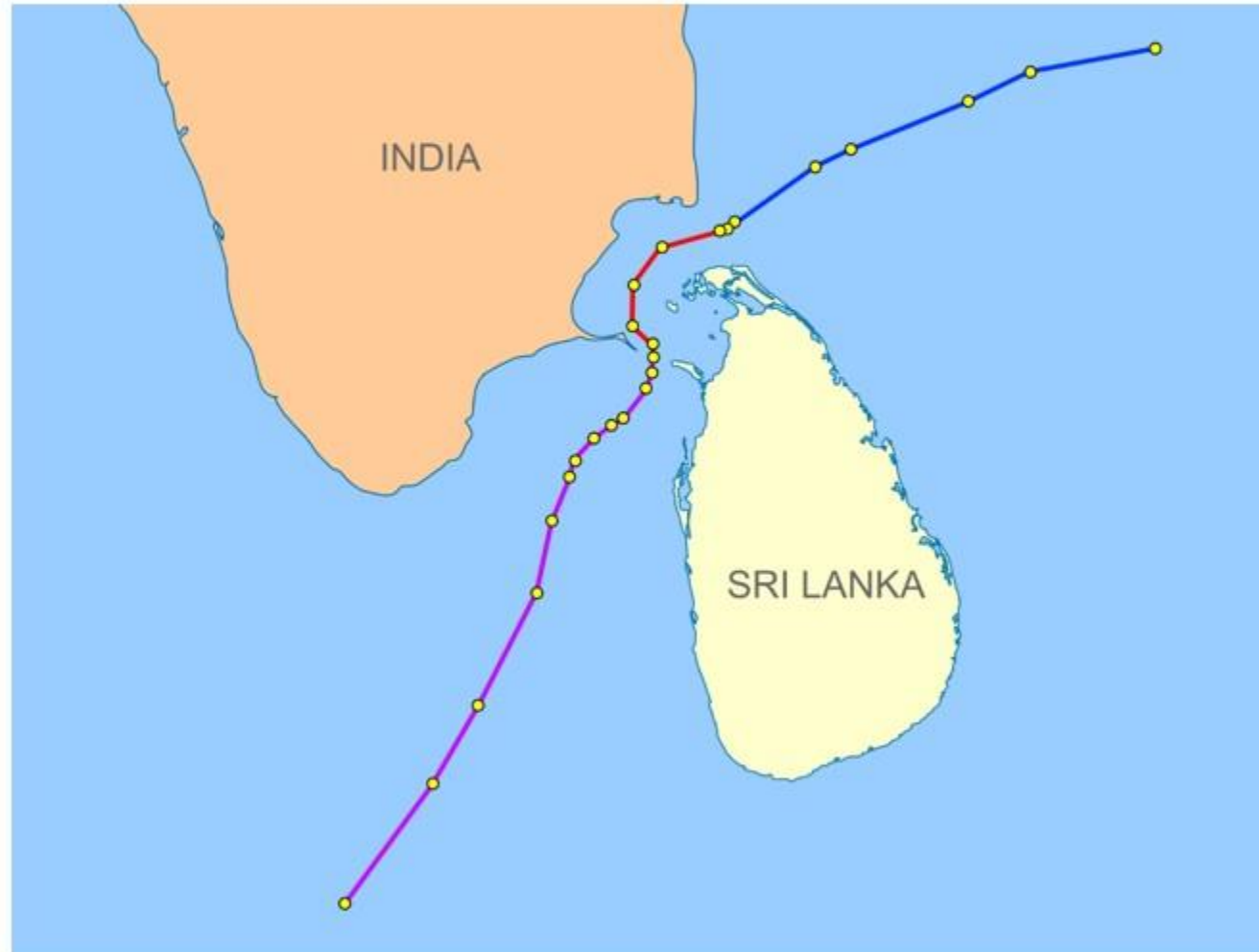
Exclusive rights to exploit resources including fish, oil and gas within 200 nautical miles. Foreign states can lay submarine pipes and cables.

GEOGRAPHICAL LOCATION

- Palk Strait
- Palk Bay
- Adam's Bridge
- Gulf of Mannar



INTERNATIONAL MARITIME BOUNDARY LINE



INDIA-SRI LANKA FISHERMEN ISSUE

ISSUE NO: 1

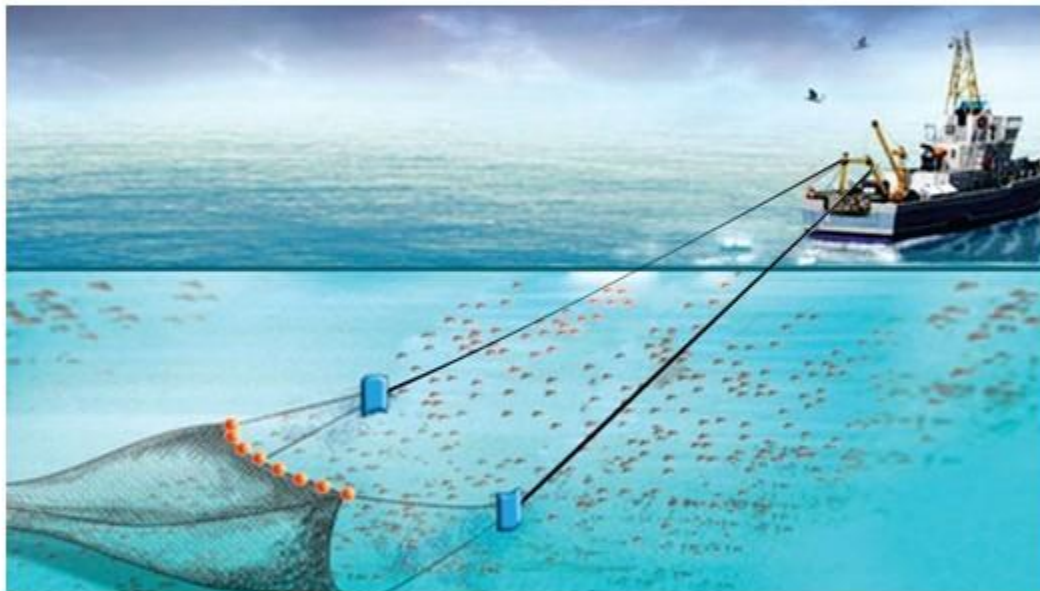


- As per the UNCLOS, Exclusive Economic Zone extends upto 200 nautical miles.
- In the case of overlapping zones, the boundary is presumed to confirm to the equi-distant principle *or* it is explicitly described in a multilateral treaty.
- Boundary pertaining to the waters of Palk Strait between two countries was signed in 1974 and with regard to Gulf of Mannar in 1976.

INDIA-SRI LANKA FISHERMEN ISSUE

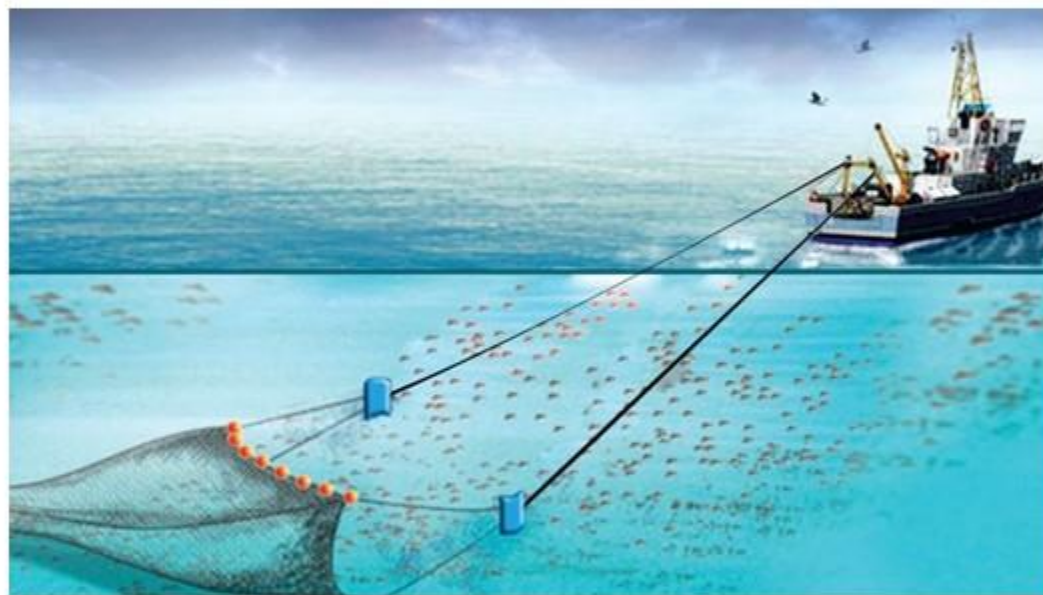
ISSUE NO: 2

BOTTOM TRAWLING



- *It is fishing method which drags large heavy nets across the sea floor.*
- *Bottom trawling disturbs the sea-bed and kills vast number of species and other animals.*
- *Scientific studies show that lot of sediment will be disturbed and the total ecosystem will be spoiled.*
- *Satellite images show that spreading of clouds of mud remain suspend in the sea long after the trawler has passed.*
- *Most of the trawlers from Tamil Nadu are owned by merchant capitalists from non-fishing and other social backgrounds and several traditional fishermen are working as labourers.*

ILL EFFECTS OF BOTTOM TRAWLING



It reinforces the need for immediate action for the sustainable management of trawling in deep marine environments.

- *One of the main causes of degradation of the seabed.*
- *It has led to meiofauna being 80% less abundant*
- *Reduce its biodiversity by 50% lower in comparison with similar areas where no trawling occurs.*
- *Decrease in the number of species of nematodes by 25%.*
- *In the long run, it causes a steady loss of fine sediments, soft and rich in organic matter.*
- *It leaves a more depleted and compacted seabed sediment surface that is more difficult to be colonized again.*



WHY IT CONCERNS INDIA?

- 1 Everyday Tamil Nadu's fisherman, regularly use hundreds of bottom trawlers in Sri Lankan territorial waters.
- 2 Fishermen's issue is contentious in political circles.
- 3 It is organised business in Tamil Nadu to have bottom trawlers.
- 4 Fisherman are venturing into the waters of Sri Lanka beyond International Maritime Boundary.

The solution lies in converting trawlers to deep sea fishing vessels



WHAT THE GOVERNMENT IS DOING?

The Central and State Governments are planning to provide 500 deep sea fishing boats with long lines and gill nets this year as part of a plan to replace 2,000 trawlers in three years.

Both the countries should ensure that the decision by Sri Lanka does not disrupt the meetings of JWG.

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SINCERE THANKS
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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

D. Sunil Kumar

V. Dayakar James

Y. Sri Poojita

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

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